HAORAN WANG

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PLACEMENT DIRECTORS

Prof. Luminita Stevens	stevens7@umd.edu	(301) 405-3515
Prof. Erkut Ozbay	ozbay@umd.edu	(301) 405-3481
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, expected May 2027
B.A. Economics and Mathematics (First Class Honors), University of Hong Kong, 2021
Visiting Undergraduate Student, Columbia University, 2018-2019

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary: Macroeconomics
Secondary: Behavioral Economics, Firm Dynamics

DISSERTATION

Firm Dynamics with Information and Behavioral Frictions
Committee: Prof. Luminita Stevens (Co-chair), Prof. John Haltiwanger (Co-chair), Prof. Boragan Aruoba, Prof. Pablo Ottonello

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Communication Frictions, Managerial Expectations, and Firm Dynamics"

Abstract: This paper studies how imperfect communication within firms shapes managerial expectations, input choices, and aggregate productivity. I develop a dynamic model of team production in which capital and labor managers share the firm's objective but observe different information about productivity. The model yields restrictions on forecast-error predictability that jointly identify communication frictions and behavioral distortions in expectations data. Empirically, investment forecasts of U.S. public firms simultaneously underreact to news about hiring and overreact to news about investment. Complementary evidence from U.S. manufacturing establishments shows that managerial forecasts underreact more to news about the other manager's decision when capital and labor decisions are made at different locations. Together, these findings are inconsistent with the common-information benchmark and support a model of firm dynamics with communication frictions. Quantitatively, communication friction generates substantial variations in the capital-labor ratio and large input misallocation. The associated aggregate productivity loss is approximately 5% relative to the frictionless allocation. This productivity loss is moderated by the negative covariance between the marginal revenue products generated by the communication friction.

WORKING PAPERS

"Innovation under Uncertainty: Perspectives from Reinforcement Learning"

"Setting the Wrong Price for the Right Reason: Consequences for Inflation and Monetary Policy," with Camilo Morales-Jimenez and Luminita Stevens

"Narrow Framing and Business Cycle Dynamics"

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Labor Wedges under Adjustment Costs", with Martim Leitao

RESEARCH AND RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Special Sworn Status Researcher, U.S. Census Bureau, 2026-present
Entrepreneurship Graduate Research Bootcamp, NBER, July 2025
Research Assistant, Prof. Pablo Ottonello, University of Maryland, Summer 2025
Behavioral Macroeconomics Graduate Research Bootcamp, NBER, May 2024
Research Assistant, Prof. Luminita Stevens, University of Maryland, Spring 2023 and Fall 2023
Sloan-Nomis Summer School on Cognitive Foundations of Economics Behavior, June 2022
Research Assistant, Prof. Jin Li, University of Hong Kong, Summer 2020 and Fall 2020
Research Assistant, Prof. Michael Woodford, Columbia University, Spring 2019 and Summer 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor (University of Maryland)
- ECON325 Intermediate Macroeconomic Analysis (undergraduate), Summer 2024, Summer 2025

Teaching Assistant (University of Maryland)
- ECON325 Intermediate Macroeconomic Analysis, Fall 2021, Fall 2022, Spring 2024
- ECON601 Macroeconomic Theory I (First-year PhD), Fall 2024, Fall 2025
- ECON602 Macroeconomic Theory II (First-year PhD), Spring 2025, Spring 2026

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Roger and Alicia Betancourt Fellowship in Applied Economics, Department of Economics, University of Maryland, Fall 2026
Graduate Assistantship, Department of Economics, University of Maryland, 2021-2026
BSOS Dean's Research Initiatives, University of Maryland, 2025
International Conference Student Support Award, Graduate School, University of Maryland, 2024
Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, Graduate School, University of Maryland, 2024
Best Third-year Paper Prize, Department of Economics, University of Maryland, 2024
Melville J. Ulmer Fellowship (Best 2nd-year Summer Paper), Department of Economics, University of Maryland, 2023
Summer Research Fellowship, Graduate School, University of Maryland, 2023
Entrance Scholarship, University of Hong Kong, 2016-2021
Dean's Honors List, Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Hong Kong, 2016-2021
Dr. Woo Hon Fai Memorial Scholarship, University of Hong Kong, 2018-2019

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: New York Fed; Maryland; EEA-ESEM Congress (Dublin); SED (Athens)*; Asian Meeting of Econometric Society (Hong Kong); Theories and Methods (T2M) in Macro (Montreal); Midwest Macro Spring Meeting (Milwaukee); Columbia*; San Francisco Fed*; Kansas City Fed*

2025: Expectations in Dynamic Macro Models Conference (Sydney)*; Reserve Bank of Australia*; Midwest Macro Fall Meeting (Cleveland Fed); Maryland; ECB*; Bundesbank*; World Congress of Econometric Society (Seoul); DC Area Macro PhD Symposium (Johns Hopkins)

2024: Econometric Society European Winter Meeting (Palma de Mallorca); Bank of Canada*; Maryland

2023: DC Area Macro PhD Symposium (Maryland)

(* Presented by Coauthors)

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Cantonese Chinese (fluent)

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Python, R, Matlab, Julia

REFERENCES

Prof. Luminita Stevens	University of Maryland	stevens7@umd.edu	(301) 405-3515
Prof. John Haltiwanger	University of Maryland	halt@umd.edu	(301) 405-3504
Prof. Pablo Ottonello	Brown University	pablo_ottonello@brown.edu	(401) 863-3836